



CALL OF JUAREZ



Draw... Yer Yella Dawg!

A classic western theme to a traditional FPS isn't oft-trodden territory. Thankfully, this game testifies to the fact that sometimes the off-beat road can be better—and uncommon isn't always un-cool!

Call of Juarez starts off with you playing Billy Candle, a half-breed about to revisit his old town and his parent's ranch. He's been somewhat of a black sheep in spite of his wee years, and it doesn't help when he finds his mother and stepfather murdered, and he's accused of doing it—by none other than Reverend Ray, Billy's uncle and padre-turned-gunfighter.

What follows is a run for the border (well not quite), as Billy makes his way out of town with his girlfriend Molly's ranch in mind as a next stop, and a posse dogging his heels. Upon arrival at the ranch, the story takes a real twist, and things heat up even more.

Throughout the game, and some well-told storytelling cutscenes, you'll play alternately as Billy and Reverend Ray, as you adventure along, using stealth and your whip (Billy), and your Bible and colts (Ray). You'll battle Red Indians, crooked lawmen, thieves, and even members of the Juarez gang (I'm not saying a word more about Juarez—play the game!). The story is pretty engrossing if not epic, and I

must say it's been implemented rather well.

Playing *Call of Juarez* is a pleasure—you'll just love Ray's shoot 'em style, especially the gunfights, where everything slows down as Ray's hands blur downwards unholstering his lead spitters. The game looks awesome, if you have the hardware to crank the visuals up (I do!), and it supports parallax mapping, HDR, and goodly doses of specular lighting effects.

Some amazing Wild West scenery comes to vibrant life—rolling hills dotted with startlingly realistic greenery, deserts complete with rock outcroppings, and the ever-swirling dust all add up to a very immersive and believable environment.

The levels are huge, and you'll frequently have to travel by horseback to get around. Sound effects are superb, well in keeping with the game's visuals.

All in all, regardless of whether you know Clint Eastwood from John Wayne, hark the *Call of Juarez*—you won't be disappointed!

michael_browne@thinkdigit.com

Rating: **8/10**
Developer: **Techland**
Publisher: **Ubisoft**
Minimum System Requirements: **1.8 GHz Pentium 4, 512 MB RAM, 128 MB video card, 4 GB free hard disk space**

